



MindShift

PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES

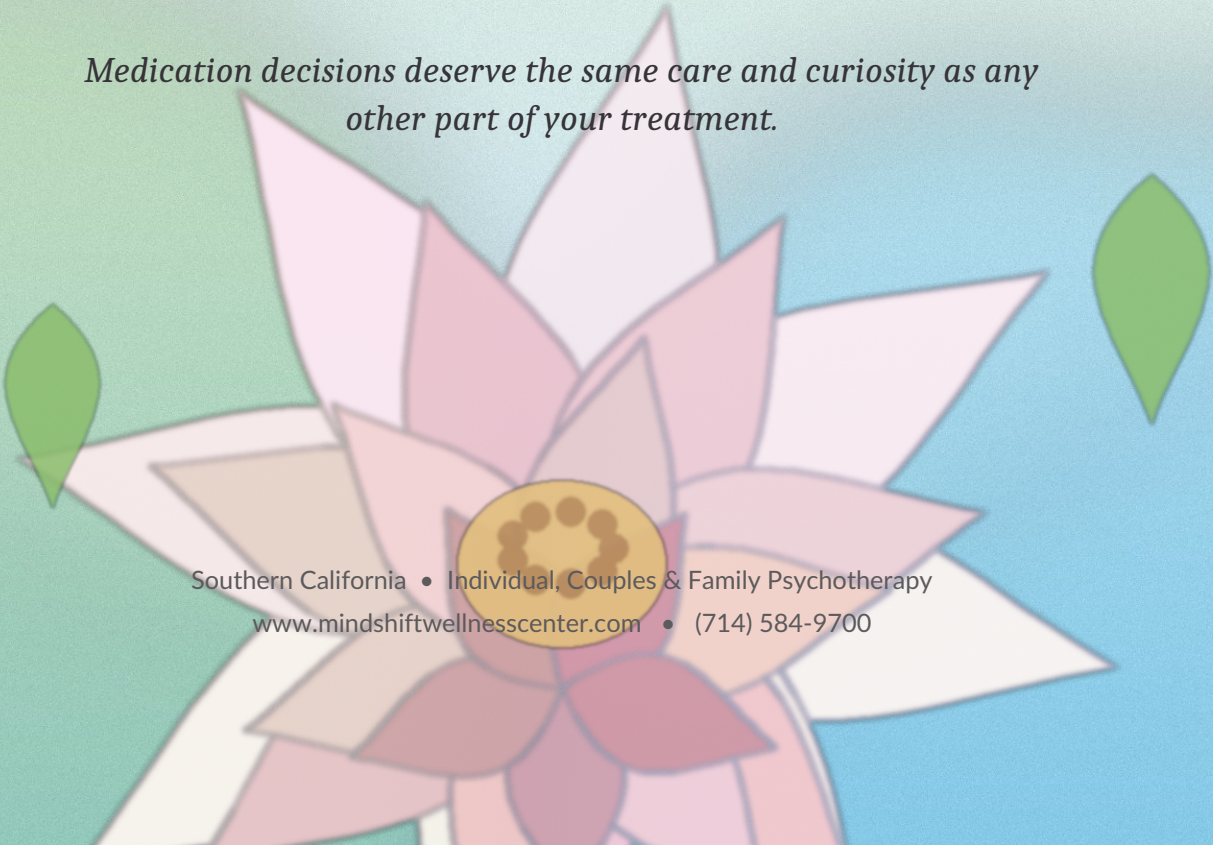


A MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES GUIDE

5 Questions to Ask When Choosing the Right Psychiatric Provider

*Medication decisions deserve the same care and curiosity as any
other part of your treatment.*

Southern California • Individual, Couples & Family Psychotherapy
www.mindshiftwellnesscenter.com • (714) 584-9700



Therapist, Psychiatrist, or Both?

NOTES & REFLECTION



Who's Who in Psychiatric Care

- Psychiatrist (MD/DO): a physician specializing in mental health, able to diagnose, prescribe, and manage complex or higher-risk cases.
- Psychiatric Mental Health Nurse Practitioner (PMHNP): an advanced-practice nurse who can evaluate, diagnose, and prescribe, often with more available appointment slots.
- Physician Assistant (PA) in psychiatry: practices under physician supervision and can also prescribe in many states.

Whichever credential your provider holds, the most important factor is whether they communicate clearly with you and, ideally, with your therapist.

Which type of provider (MD/DO, PMHNP, PA) sounds like the right starting point for you?

Ask These Five

A thorough provider asks about your full history, medical and psychological, before recommending anything, not just a five-minute symptom checklist.

This includes asking whether therapy alone, or alongside medication, is a reasonable option for you right now.

Most psychiatric medications need 4-6 weeks of consistent use to show full effect. Ask what's normal to expect early on versus what warrants a call.

Jot down how a provider answers question 1, 2, and 3 during your appointment.



Two More, Plus a Safety Note

Stopping many psychiatric medications abruptly can cause withdrawal-like symptoms. A good provider will walk you through a plan before you ever need to use it.

Ask how they share updates with your therapist (with your consent) so your care feels like one team, not two disconnected appointments.

Never stop or change a psychiatric medication on your own. Always consult your prescriber first, even if you're feeling better.

Jot down how a provider answers question 4 and 5, plus anything you still want to ask.



BRING THIS WITH YOU

My Appointment Prep Sheet

Bring a full list of what you currently take, prescriptions, over-the-counter, and supplements.

Current medications & supplements:

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Symptoms I most want addressed:

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Questions I want answered today:

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My therapist's name & contact (for coordination):

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BEFORE YOU GO

You Don't Have to Carry This Alone

Medication is one tool among many, and it works best alongside therapy and a provider who takes time to explain the “why” behind every recommendation. Our team can help you find both.

Rachael Morua, LMFT, CST

License #LMFT106917 • Founder, MindShift Psychological Services
On behalf of the licensed clinicians of the MindShift care team

MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES

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IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS

Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911. You deserve support right now.



Visit Our Website



Contact Us to Get Started

